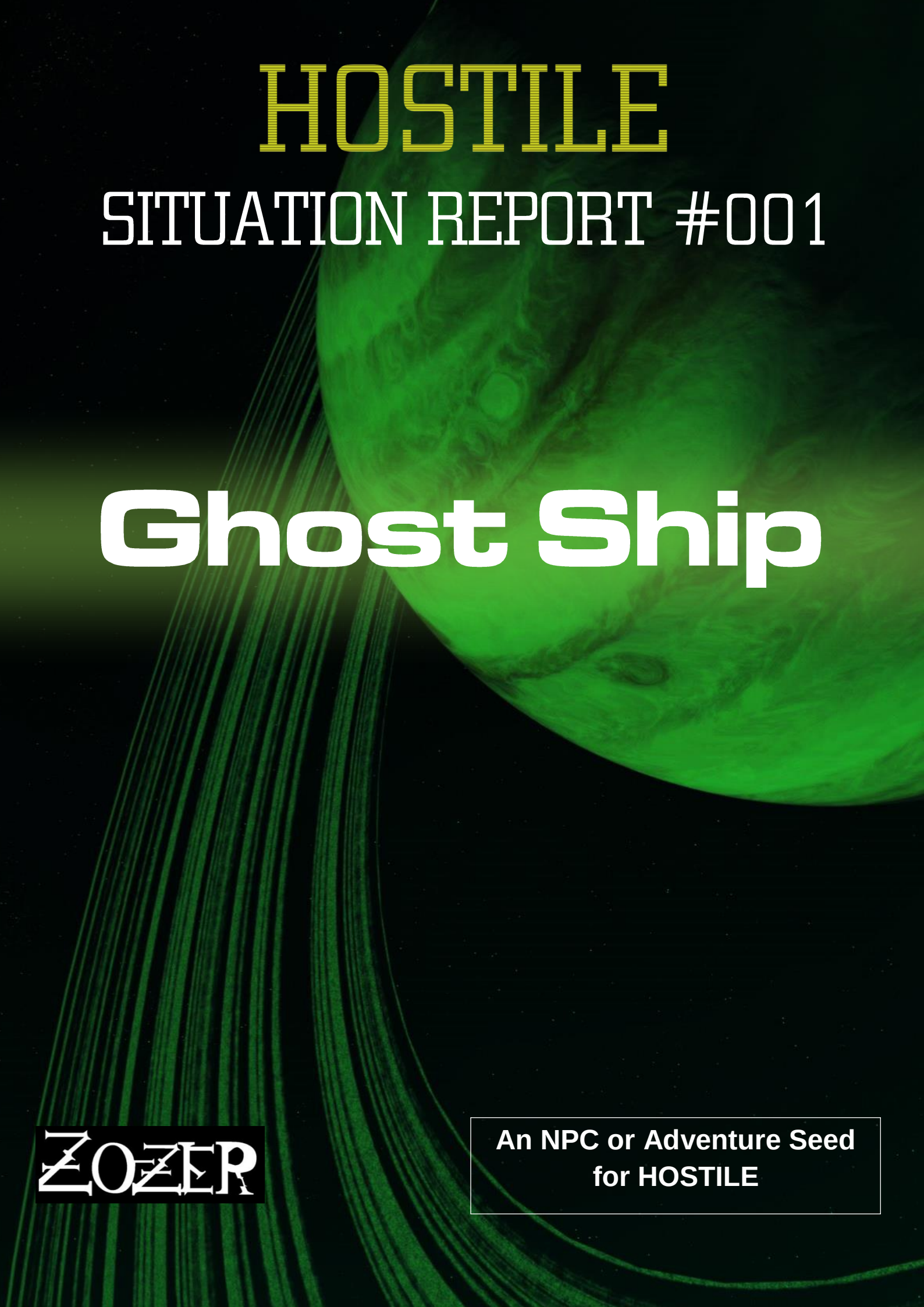




HOSTILE

SITUATION REPORT #001

Ghost Ship

ZOZER

An NPC or Adventure Seed
for HOSTILE

GHOST SHIP [Scenario]

A scenario seed for the **HOSTILE** sci-fi setting: www.paulelliottbooks.com/hostile.html

ASSUMPTIONS

The PCs are the crew of a ship, maybe a freighter, salvage craft, survey ship, military patrol ship, mining vessel, shuttle, etc. They encounter a ship seemingly abandoned in a low orbit over a gas giant in some remote star system. They investigate, either for salvage, curiosity or because they were ordered to. The referee can set this in any system with a gas giant. The target ship can be decided by the referee, use one you have deckplans for, or one that fits the star system.

PLAYER'S BRIEFING

As the PCs' ship makes its way across the star system, perhaps to refuel at the local gas giant or detouring close to a gas giant for some gravity assist to reach the mainworld or hyperspace point, the sensor operator picks up a mayday signal from a ship in low orbit. At medium range (10,000 km) the ship can be identified by its transponder signal: it is called the 'Eldridge'. Its trajectory takes it on a path along the very top of the planet's atmosphere. A Nav roll reveals it cannot have sustained that path without frequent burns from the main engine.

HOOK-UP & TROUBLE

The Eldridge is unresponsive. The PCs must dock with the ship which is an Average Pilot task taking 1D6 minutes. If failed, they may attempt again, but the Eldridge begins a slow descent into the atmosphere and opens its fuel scoops to take in hydrogen fuel. This makes docking Difficult. If they abort and wait, the ship returns to low orbit in 2 hours and the PCs can try again. The ship repeats this cycle every 2 hours which is not normal. Extreme Failure indicates the PC's ship took damage.

ON-BOARD AT LAST

The Eldridge scooped up a deadly alien necrotizing virus from the atmosphere which has devoured the crew, reducing their flesh to bone. The crew sit in their seats or lay sprawled on the deck in sealed vacc suits, but only skeletons remain within... If the PCs ever expose themselves or their ship to the Eldridge's atmosphere, they risk being contaminated by the virus. Roll V/Diff End to resist the virus, success means rashes, itching and skin flaking for one hour. Failure means the same, but after one hour victims begin to lose 1pt of Str every minute. After Str, points are taken from Dex, then End, until dead. Unconsciousness comes when Str and Dex are at 0. Stasis in a hypersleep chamber or autodoc will halt its progress but not cure it.

The Eldridge's crew activated the mayday, donned vacc suits to save themselves, then died, leaving the computer to continue its programmed refuelling scoop mission – even though the tanks are now full. Can the PCs override the computer and save the ship, if not the crew? With samples from the crew, a medic can tailor a vaccine in 2D6 hours with a Difficult medical roll (or Average if one of the PCs has the virus). For drama, have an engine fail and the ship begin a spiral into the atmosphere, made more tense if any PC victims have been put into hypersleep on the Eldridge!

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